BRANDON HALL
HOTEL & SPA

HEAD OF DEPARTMENT FIRE SAFETY MANUAL

Housekeeping and laundry

Fire safety training, procedures and checks

Brandon Hall Hotel and Spa
Main Street, Brandon, Coventry CV8 3FW

Version 1.1 · 30 October 2026. Prepared for the heads of department following the Warwickshire Fire and Rescue Service inspection of 27 October 2026. Based on the Regulatory Reform (Fire Safety) Order 2005, HM Government guidance "Fire safety risk assessment: sleeping accommodation" and the hotel's fire risk assessment. Fire Safety Manager: Glenn Randell. Fire Training Coordinator: Patrik Vlach.

About this manual

This manual is for the head of the **Housekeeping and laundry** department (Head Housekeeper). It explains how fire safety works in your department, what your team must do, and how to train them using HosFIRE, the hotel's online fire safety system. Every training completion and fire check recorded in HosFIRE appears automatically on the hotel's training matrix and fire records, which the fire service can inspect.

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Key information

Emergency	999 — Fire and Rescue. Reception (or whoever is free first at night) calls on every activation.
Address for 999	Brandon Hall Hotel and Spa, Main Street, Brandon, Coventry CV8 3FW
Evacuation	Simultaneous — everyone leaves when the alarm sounds. Never use the lift.
Assembly point	Out of the front door, turn right, across the car park.
Main fire alarm panel	Main entrance, down the disabled ramp.
Fire Safety Manager	Glenn Randell, Maintenance Manager
Fire Training Coordinator	Patrik Vlach, Front Office Manager
Fire marshals	Patrik Vlach, Veronica Webb, Laith Hardy, Glenn Randell
Fire alarm faults	Leader Systems — 01788 542 220

1. Your role as head of department

The law (Regulatory Reform (Fire Safety) Order 2005, Article 21) requires every member of staff to be given fire safety training when they start, when risks change and repeated regularly after that. As head of department you make sure this happens for everyone in your team, including part-time, casual and agency staff.

You will

- Read this manual and confirm online using the HOD confirmation QR code (section 2) by Monday 2 November 2026.
- Make sure every current member of your team completes the online fire safety induction by Saturday 7 November 2026.
- Make sure every new starter completes the online induction before their first shift, and show them your area using the new starter area tour (section 10).
- Make sure everyone completes the monthly refresher by the 20th of each month, and chase anyone outstanding.
- Make sure your department's fire checks are done and recorded on time (section 7).
- Tell the Fire Training Coordinator (Patrik Vlach) about new starters, leavers, and anyone who would need help to evacuate.
- Report anything unsafe straight away to the duty manager or the Fire Safety Manager.

Key dates

When	What
By 2 November 2026	HOD confirms this manual online (QR code in section 2)
By 7 November 2026	Every current member of the team completes the online fire safety induction
Before the first shift	Every new starter completes the online induction; area tour on day one
1st working day of each month	Training Coordinator launches the monthly refresher; brief your team
10th of each month	Training Coordinator sends you the list of who is outstanding
20th of each month	Deadline: everyone in your team has completed the monthly refresher
Every 12 months	Everyone repeats the full induction (annual refresher)
At least twice a year	Fire drill, including one at night

How completion shows on the training matrix

When a member of staff completes training online, HosFIRE records their name, date, score and signature and updates the training matrix automatically: the induction updates *Fire induction*, *Annual refresher* and *Fire procedure briefing*; the monthly refresher updates *Monthly fire refresher*. Anyone not yet on the matrix is added under your department. The Fire Training Coordinator and managers see, by department, who is complete and who is outstanding in HosFIRE → Training.

2. Your QR codes

Scan with a phone camera. Every page asks for the staff code **999**, then the person's own name. Nothing needs to be installed.

Staff fire training — Housekeeping and laundry

Induction for new starters and the monthly refresher for everyone.

Staff code 999

https://brandon.hospro.co.uk/hosfire-training.html?dept=housekeeping

Head of department confirmation

For you: confirm you have read this manual.

Staff code 999

https://brandon.hospro.co.uk/hosfire-training.html?dept=housekeeping&hod=1

Fire checks

Record your department's fire checks on the day.

Staff code 999

https://brandon.hospro.co.uk/hosfire-checks.html

What your staff do

1. Scan the staff training QR code and enter the staff code 999.
2. Type their full name (first and last name). New people choose their department and start date.
3. Choose the fire safety induction (new starters and anyone not yet done) or this month's refresher.
4. Read each section, answer the questions (induction pass mark 8 out of 10; refresher 3 out of 3) and sign on screen.
5. A certificate is shown and the training matrix is updated straight away.

No phone? Staff can use the office computer or the reception tablet with you. If a member of staff has difficulty reading English, go through the training with them, read each section aloud and let them answer and sign for themselves.

3. How to train your team

A. New starters — before and on their first shift

- Before the first shift: they complete the online fire safety induction (about 15 minutes) using the staff training QR code.
- On the first shift: walk them round your area using the new starter area tour (section 10). Show them the exits, call points, extinguishers, fire action notices, the assembly point and the hazards in your department.
- You and the new starter both sign the area tour. Keep it in their staff file and tell the Training Coordinator they have started.
- Casual and agency staff are included: no-one works a shift without completing the induction.

B. Monthly refresher — every member of staff, every month

- On the first working day of the month, the Training Coordinator tells you the topic (see the calendar in section 9).
- At your next team briefing, spend five minutes on the topic: read the key message, point out where it applies in your area, and show the QR code poster.
- Staff complete the refresher on their phone (about 3 minutes). Record the briefing on the monthly team briefing record (section 10).
- On the 10th you receive the list of who is outstanding. Chase them. Everyone must be complete by the 20th.
- Anyone still outstanding after the 20th is reported to management by the Training Coordinator.

C. Every year

- Everyone repeats the full online induction within 12 months of their last one. The training matrix shows when each person is due (amber within 30 days, red overdue).

D. Fire drills

- At least twice a year, including one with the night team. Drills are organised by the Fire Safety Manager and recorded in HosFIRE.
- After a drill, talk your team through anything that went wrong.

E. Tips for a good five-minute briefing

- Do it where the hazard is: by the fire door, the fryer, the dryer, the panel.
- Ask questions rather than lecture: “Where is our nearest call point?”, “What do you do if you smell gas?”
- Point out one real thing you have seen recently (a wedged door, a blocked exit) and what should have happened.
- Keep it positive. Thank people who report hazards.

4. Fire procedure — every member of staff

If you discover a fire

- Raise the alarm: break the nearest red fire alarm call point.
- Get out and close doors behind you to hold the fire back.
- Only use an extinguisher if the fire is small, you are trained, and your way out is behind you. If in doubt, get out.
- Tell the duty manager or reception where the fire is.

When the alarm sounds

- Brandon Hall uses SIMULTANEOUS evacuation: everyone leaves as soon as the alarm sounds.
- Leave by the nearest safe exit. Never use the lift.
- Help guests out of your area; close doors as you go. Don't stop to collect belongings.
- Go to the assembly point: out of the front door, turn right, across the car park. Report to the duty manager for the roll call.
- Never go back in until the fire service says it is safe.

Preventing fire every day

- Never wedge or prop open a fire door. Fire doors hold back fire and smoke.
- Keep corridors, stairs and fire exits clear — no trolleys, linen or boxes.
- Don't overload sockets; report damaged plugs, cables and appliances.
- Clean dryer lint filters after every load. Keep bins and rubbish away from the building.
- No smoking except in the designated area. Candles only in approved enclosed holders.

Fire extinguishers

Label colour	Type	Use on	Never use on
Red	Water	Paper, wood, fabric	Electrical equipment, cooking oil
Cream	Foam	Paper, wood, fabric, flammable liquids	Cooking oil; live electrics unless the label allows
Black	CO_2	Electrical equipment	Cooking oil
Blue	Powder	Plant rooms, mixed fires	Kitchens and enclosed occupied spaces
Yellow	Wet chemical	Cooking oil and fat (fryers)	—
Fire blanket	—	Small pan fires, clothing on fire	—

P-A-S-S: Pull the pin, Aim at the base of the fire, Squeeze the handle, Sweep side to side. Only tackle a small fire if you are trained and your way out is behind you. If in doubt, get out.

5. Fire risks and controls — housekeeping and laundry

Housekeeping sees every bedroom every day and runs the laundry. That makes the team our eyes and ears for fire hazards in guest rooms, and responsible for one of the most common causes of hotel fires: hot linen and tumble-dryer lint.

Laundry and tumble dryers

- Clean the lint filters after every load (record it daily in HosFIRE Checks — Laundry lint and dryer check).
- Hot linen can catch fire by itself (spontaneous combustion), especially towels and robes with oils from the spa. Always run the cool-down cycle, take linen out and spread it out to cool. Never leave hot linen piled up or in a bag.
- Never leave dryers running when the laundry is unattended or at the end of the shift.
- Keep the area around the dryers clear of linen, boxes and chemicals.

Chemicals (COSHH)

- Store chemicals in their original labelled containers in the chemical store, away from heat and electrical equipment.
- Never mix chemicals. Bleach (chlorine) mixed with acid toilet cleaners or descalers produces toxic gas.
- Aerosols and solvent-based products are flammable: keep them away from heat and never leave them on a trolley in the sun or near a heater.
- Read the safety data sheets and use the PPE provided.

Trolleys, linen and storage

- Never leave trolleys, linen or rubbish on escape routes, landings, in stairwells or in front of fire doors.
- Linen cupboard and store doors are often fire doors: keep them closed. Never wedge them open.
- Never store linen or boxes in plant rooms, electrical cupboards or under stairs.

Checking bedrooms

- Report straight away: smoke detectors that are covered (for example with a shower cap or bag), damaged or bleeping; fire action notices missing from the back of the door; bedroom doors that do not close by themselves.
- Report signs of smoking, candles, guest-owned heaters, cooking equipment or overloaded sockets.
- Switch off and report hair straighteners, irons and other appliances left on or damaged.
- Report scorch marks, damaged plugs, cables or lamps.

6. When the alarm sounds — your department

Everyone

- Leave by the nearest safe exit as soon as the alarm sounds. Brandon Hall uses simultaneous evacuation: everyone leaves.
- Never use the lift. Close doors behind you.
- Help guests in your area to leave; do not stop to collect belongings.
- Go to the assembly point and report to the duty manager for the roll call.
- Never go back in until the fire service says it is safe.

Housekeeping and laundry — in addition

- Leave your trolley out of the escape route (into a room or store) if you can do it immediately.
- On your way out, knock on doors and call out in the area you are working in. Do not go back for anyone — tell the duty manager.
- Turn off dryers and laundry equipment only if you can do it in seconds.
- At the assembly point, tell the duty manager which rooms you know were occupied and anyone you could not reach.

7. Your department's fire checks

Check	How often	Who	What it covers
Laundry lint and dryer check BHH-FS-07	Every day	Housekeeping lead	Lint filters cleaned after every load; Area around dryers clear of linen and combustibles; Dryers off and linen cooled and spread before leaving Every day by the housekeeping lead or the person running the laundry.

All checks are recorded on the day in **HosFIRE Checks** (QR code in this manual, staff code 999). Each record is saved under the name of the person who did it, with the date and time. Any item marked **Fail** creates an action for the Fire Safety Manager automatically. Never fill in a check for a day it was not done; if a check was missed, record it on the day you do it and tell your manager.

8. Know your area

Fill this in during your own walk-round and use it when you show new starters round. If anything is missing, damaged or not where it should be, tell the Fire Safety Manager.

Item	Where it is in our area
Nearest exits and stairs from each floor you work on	
Nearest manual call points	
Nearest extinguishers and type	
Laundry: dryer isolator / emergency stop	
Chemical (COSHH) store	
Linen stores (fire doors to keep closed)	
Assembly point	
Nearest fire exits	
Nearest fire action notice	

Completed by (HOD): _____ Date: _____

9. Monthly refresher calendar

One topic each month for every member of staff. The online refresher opens on the 1st and must be completed by the 20th.

Month	Refresher topic	Key message for your team briefing
November 2026	Arson prevention	Keep bins and rubbish away from the building and lock bin stores. Report anyone acting suspiciously and any small fires or burn marks.
December 2026	Contractors and hot work	Contractors sign in, are told the fire procedure and sign out. Hot work (welding, grinding, blow-torches) needs a hot work permit from the hotel before it starts.
January 2027	Fire doors	Fire doors hold back fire and smoke for at least 30 minutes — but only when closed. Never wedge or prop them open. Report doors that don't close fully, damaged seals or missing signs.
February 2027	Escape routes and exits	Corridors, stairs and fire exits must be clear at all times. Final exit doors must open from inside without a key while the hotel is in use.
March 2027	Raising the alarm and calling 999	Break the nearest red call point if you see a fire. Reception calls 999 on every activation — never assume someone else has.
April 2027	Fire extinguishers and blankets	Red = water, cream = foam, black = CO_2, blue = powder, yellow = wet chemical. Only tackle a small fire if trained and your exit is behind you. P-A-S-S.
May 2027	Kitchen fire safety	Never leave cooking unattended. Keep extract filters clean. Know where the gas shut-off and fire blanket are. Never use water on oil.
June 2027	Electrical safety	Don't overload sockets or daisy-chain extension leads. Report damaged plugs, cables or appliances and stop using them.
July 2027	Housekeeping, laundry and storage	Clean dryer lint filters after every load; don't leave dryers running unattended at the end of a shift. Keep linen and chemicals away from heaters, lights and electrical panels.
August 2027	Helping guests and night time	Guests needing help to evacuate are identified at check-in (PEEP); night staff know who they are. At night there are fewer staff — knock on doors and call out as you leave.
September 2027	Evacuation and the assembly point	Simultaneous evacuation — everyone leaves when the alarm sounds. Never use the lift. Go to the assembly point: out of the front door, turn right, across the car park. Never go back in.
October 2027	Smoking, candles and events	Smoking only in the designated area; bins for cigarette ends. Candles only in enclosed holders, away from drapes and exits. Check event numbers against the room's limit.

10. Forms

New starter area tour — Housekeeping and laundry

Complete on the new starter's first shift. The online induction must already be done.

Name	
Start date	
Online induction completed on	

☐	Fire exits and escape routes from our area
☐	Nearest manual call points and how to raise the alarm
☐	Nearest extinguishers, fire blanket and which to use
☐	Fire action notice and the assembly point
☐	Do not use the lift; close doors behind you
☐	Shown the exits and call points on each floor
☐	Shown the laundry and the lint filter / cool-down routine
☐	Knows hot linen can self-heat and must be spread to cool
☐	Knows the chemical store and never to mix chemicals
☐	Knows what to report from bedrooms (covered detectors, notices, doors)
☐	Knows where to leave the trolley when the alarm sounds

New starter signature	Head of department signature	Date

Monthly team briefing record — Housekeeping and laundry

Record each monthly five-minute briefing. Staff still complete the online refresher; this sheet shows the briefing took place.

Date	Topic	Staff present	Points raised / actions	HOD signature

Head of department confirmation — Housekeeping and laundry

Please confirm online using the QR code below (this records your confirmation in HosFIRE), and also sign this page and give it to the Fire Training Coordinator.

Confirm online

Staff code 999

- ☐ I have read this fire safety manual for my department.
- ☐ Every member of my team, including casual and agency staff, will complete the online fire safety induction: current staff by 7 November 2026 and new starters before their first shift.
- ☐ Every member of my team will complete the monthly refresher by the 20th of each month, and I will chase anyone outstanding.
- ☐ I will show every new starter our area on their first shift and sign the new starter area tour.
- ☐ I will make sure my department's fire checks are done and recorded on time, and report anything unsafe straight away.
- ☐ I will tell the Fire Training Coordinator about new starters, leavers and anyone who needs help to evacuate.

Name	Job title	Signature	Date

Received by the Fire Training Coordinator

Name	Signature	Date

BRANDON HALL
HOTEL & SPA

Fire safety training

Housekeeping and laundry team

New starters: complete the fire safety induction before your first shift.
Everyone: complete the monthly refresher by the 20th of every month.

Staff code: **999**

Scan with your phone camera · https://brandon.hospro.co.uk/hosfire-training.html?dept=housekeeping